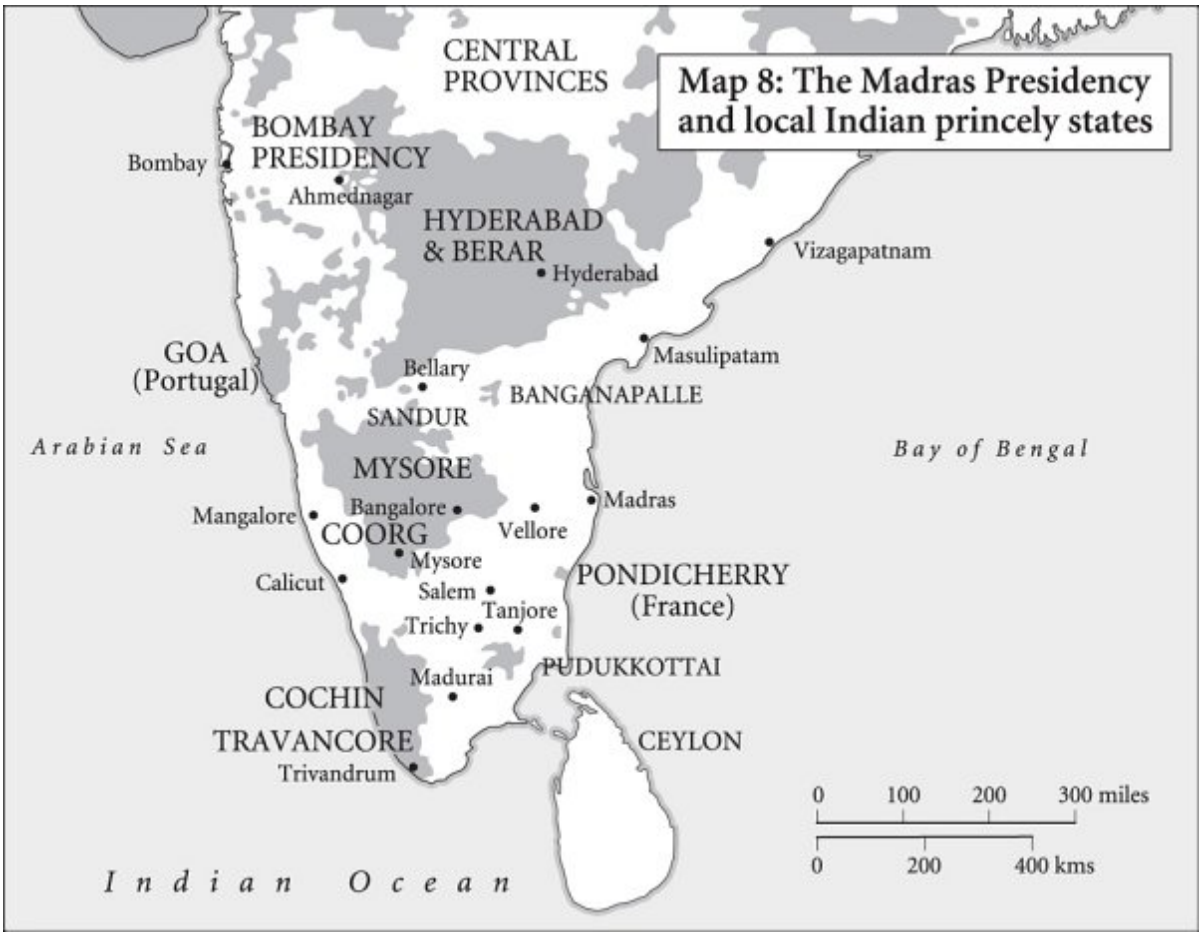
make their plight worse, those now living under EICo government found that the rules of land ownership had changed. The Jenmi landlords, largely made up of Nairs and Brahmins, now became absolute owners of the land, free to charge their Kanakkaran tenant-farmers as much rent as they could exact from them. These Kanakkaran then did the same with the peasant cultivators who worked the land, the Verumpattakkaran, mostly made up of Mappilas and Hindus of the Ezhava cultivator caste – with inevitable consequences.



The great uprising of 1857 which the British called the Sepoy or Indian Mutiny had relatively little impact on South India. We should remember that there was at this time no overarching sense of national ‘Indian’ identity, especially so